

poet has it.

A Female Crusoe.

SANTA BARBARA, Cal., Sept 11, 1853.

We have now in Santa Barbara a great curiosity; it is an Indian woman, who has lived eighteen years alone upon the Island of St. Nicholas—a small island about forty-five miles from this place, during which time she has not seen the face of a human being. This island was once peopled by a tribe of Indians, to whom the northwest tribes were hostile. To preserve the remnant of this tribe from destruction, as well as with a view to christianize them, the padres induced them to come to the main land eighteen years ago. After they were all on board the vessel sent for them, this woman swam ashore to look for her child which had been left; and a storm springing up in the night, the vessel was compelled to put to sea, and on returning, she could not be found. She was known to be alive by those who at times visited the island for the purpose of hunting others, from the marks of fires and from foot prints in the sand.

On being approached the other day she manifested much joy, which she betrayed by signs of the most significant character, and at once commenced packing her few articles of furniture. Her clothing consists of skins of birds sewed together with the fibers of some trees or plants. Her food has been shell-fish, seals, and a small bulbous root, similar in appearance to an onion, but wholly tasteless. The needles with which she stitches her garments are made of the sharp bones of a fish. She had two hooks made of a bent nail and sharpened by friction on a stone. Her lines were beautifully twisted from the sinews of some animal, probably a species of fox which abounds on the island.

TIME.—It awaits for no man—it travels